

CANOVA Pilot Roadmap

A Phased Model for Community-Backed Sustainability

Phase One: Farmers' Market Vendor Pilot

Location: Cambridge Farmers' Market (or St. Jacobs as an alternative)

Participants: Vendors only, no shoppers involved

Timeline: 8–12 weeks

How It Works

- Vendors earn CANOVA credits weekly for verified sustainable practices such as:
 - Using reusable or compostable packaging
 - Reducing material or food waste
 - Sourcing locally
 - Participating in eco-friendly actions at the market
- Vendors **submit a weekly form** to log their actions
- For every 5 points earned, vendors receive **1 CANOVA note** (physical, pilot-only edition)
- Notes can be **quietly exchanged** between participating vendors for products, discounts, or services

Purpose & Benefits

- Tests the system in a **small, closed-loop** environment
- Ensures simplicity and control during early stages
- Builds **trust and buy-in** from the market's core community
- Creates early metrics, stories, and success visuals

- Demonstrates how CANOVA rewards stewardship without requiring digital tools
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Phase Two: Expanded Community Pilot

Location: Downtown Galt & Partner Institutions

Participants: Students, volunteers, small businesses, community services

Timeline: Launches after Pilot 1

How It Works

Participants **earn CANOVA** by taking part in sustainability actions through trusted institutions:

- **Rare Charitable Research Reserve** – habitat restoration, cleanups, native planting
- **Conestoga College** – student projects, tree planting, research-based sustainability
- **Grand River Conservation Authority (GRCA)** – shoreline cleanups, volunteer restoration

Participants **spend CANOVA** at:

- **Idea Exchange (Library/Maker Hub)** – access to programs, workshops, digital tools
- **Local cafés and shops** – coffee, discounts, community products
- **Community services** – potential access to day passes, classes, or basic needs (YMCA, Food Bank, etc.)

Purpose & Benefits

- Moves CANOVA from vendor recognition into **community circulation**
- Connects multiple sectors: education, environment, small business, and services
- Demonstrates **scalability and flexibility** of the system
- Increases visibility and participation across age groups and sectors
- Builds community pride and inclusive local economies

Why a Phased Model?

PHASE ONE

Controlled,
measurable

Vendor trust

Offline-friendly

Builds credibility



PHASE TWO



Diverse, multi-sector reach



Community-wide buy-in



Bridges to broader applications



Demonstrates scalable use
cases

CANOVA is:

- A **secondary economy** built on sustainability, care, and trust
- A **pilot-tested system** that rewards regenerative action
- A new way to **create and circulate value** without extraction

This roadmap marks the beginning of a different approach. A system that recognizes care, rewards stewardship, and strengthens the communities that uphold both.

CANOVA treats restoration as a form of wealth. We are testing a quiet but radical shift: moving value away from extraction, and placing it in the hands of those who restore, protect, and give back.

These pilots will show how Waterloo Region can lead the shift from extractive thinking to regenerative practice.

Prepared by:

Julie Jamieson

juliesjamieson@gmail.com

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